



Darul-ilm Kent Parent Handbook

Academic Year 2026 – 2027

Weekday & Weekend Islamic Education for Ages 5 – 16, at our Chatham and Gillingham sites

Admin: 07778 020745 • info@darulilmchatham.com • school.darulilmkent.org

Welcome to Darul-ilm Kent

Assalāmu ‘alaykum wa raḥmatullāhi wa barakātuh, dear parents and carers,

We are delighted to welcome your family to Darul-ilm Kent. This handbook is designed to give you everything you need to know about how the Madrasa runs, what we ask of you and your child, and what you can expect from us in return, so that this year gets off to the best possible start, in shā’ Allāh.

Your child's Islamic education is a trust (amānah), and we take that responsibility seriously. We aim to provide a safe, structured, and nurturing environment in which every child can build a lifelong love of the Qur'an, sound Islamic knowledge, and strong character (akhlāq).

Not everything can be captured in a handbook, and we are always happy to discuss any questions or concerns you may have. Please do not hesitate to contact the admin office.

With very best wishes,

Mufti Didar Hasan

Co-Founder & Head of Education

Academic year

2026 – 2027

Issued to

All parents and guardians of enrolled pupils, ages
5 – 16

Co-Founder & Head of Education

Mufti Didar Hasan

Sites

Chatham Hill Mosque, 22A Chatham Hill,
Chatham, ME5 7AA

Gillingham (KMWA Mosque), 114 Canterbury St,
Gillingham, ME7 5UH

Admin contact

WhatsApp / message: 07778 020745

Email

info@darulilmchatham.com

admin@darulilmchatham.com

Website

school.darulilmkent.org

Related policies

Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy, Behaviour
Policy, Fees Policy, Parents' Code of Conduct &
Parent Agreement

Important numbers

Mufti Didar Hasan (Co-Founder & Head Teacher):
07534979369

Ustadha Zulfa Tanzim (Co-Founder & Manager):
07587697210



About Darul-ilm Kent

Our Madrasa

Darul-ilm Kent is a weekday and weekend Madrasa serving children from the age of 5 across our Chatham and Gillingham sites. We exist to give every child a strong foundation in Qur'an, Islamic knowledge, and character, alongside the mainstream education they receive elsewhere, in a safe and supportive environment.

We are proud of the diverse and close-knit community of families who make up our Madrasa, and we see your child's education as a partnership between home and Madrasa, not something that happens in isolation.

Our Vision & Core Values

Our vision is to develop students with clear Islamic knowledge, a genuine love for Allah and His Messenger ﷺ, and lives guided by taqwā (God-consciousness).

Our mission is to build children up with comprehensive Islamic foundations, where success means not just memorisation but understanding, love, and living application of faith, guiding students towards Qur'an memorisation, service of their religion, and taqwā-centred living.

This is reflected in six core values that shape how we teach and run the Madrasa:

Knowledge Taught with Excellence

Every Islamic subject is taught in a way children understand, engage with, and find interesting.

Heart Before Memorisation

Success is measured by a child's love and connection to their learning, not only by what they have memorised.

Taqwā as Daily Practice

God-consciousness is expected to extend beyond the classroom into how a student conducts themselves day to day.

Service as a Natural Progression

Capable students are gradually introduced to helping and teaching others as they progress.

Individual Student Support

Every child receives personalised attention, whatever their academic trajectory.

Home-Madrasa Partnership

A child's religious development is a shared responsibility between the Madrasa and parents, not something either can achieve alone.

Our Sites, Admissions & The Madrasa Day

Our Sites

Chatham

Chatham Hill Mosque, 22A Chatham Hill, Chatham, ME5 7AA – weekday and weekend classes.

Gillingham

KMWA Mosque, 114 Canterbury St, Gillingham, ME7 5UH – weekend classes.

Children are enrolled at one site according to preference and availability. Both sites follow the same policies, curriculum, and standards set out in this handbook.

Admissions & Enrolment

Places at Darul-ilm Kent are limited, and most classes currently operate a waiting list. To apply, please complete the registration form on our website, school.darulilmkent.org, on the page for your preferred site (Chatham or Gillingham), or contact the admin directly. Places are offered subject to availability in the relevant age group, site, and session.

Once a place is offered, you'll be sent a link to our online enrolment form alongside this handbook. This is where you confirm you've read the handbook, agree to its commitments, and set your photography & social media preference, and it's the step that – together with the resources fee – confirms your child's place.

The Madrasa Day

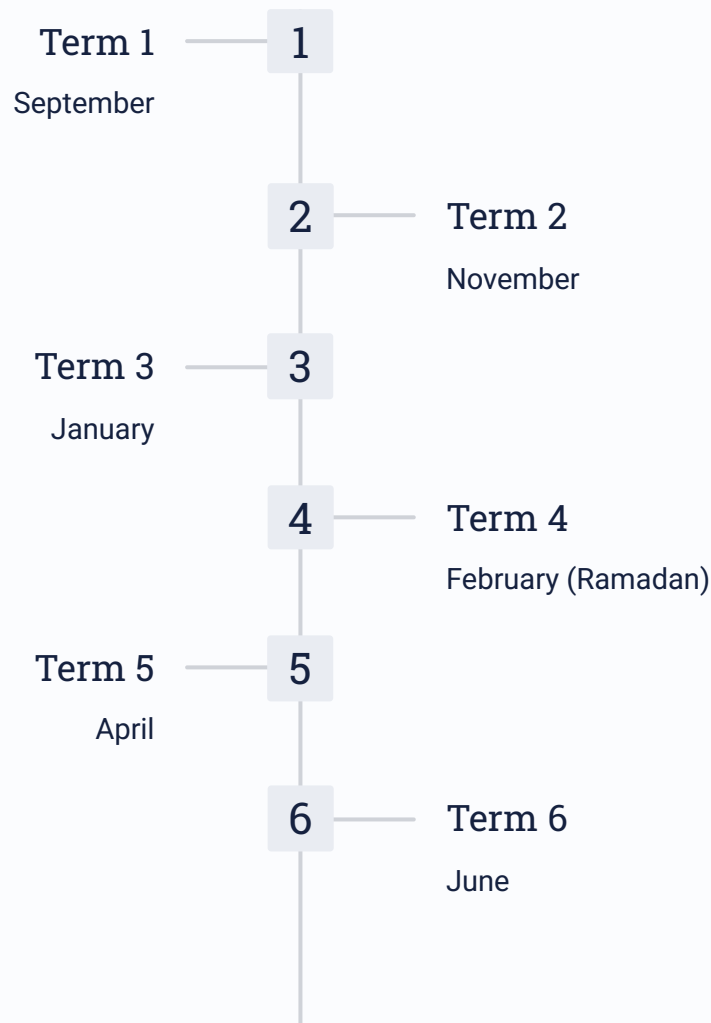
Each site runs classes in fixed sessions, and a child is placed into one session for the year; attendance on every class day of that session is required. Please arrive a few minutes before the session start and collect your child promptly at the end.

Chatham	Session 1	Session 2
Weekday (Mon – Thu)	4:30 – 6:00 pm	6:10 – 7:40 pm
Weekend (Sat & Sun)	9:45 am – 1:00 pm	2:00 – 5:00 pm
Gillingham	Session times	
Weekend (Sat & Sun)	9:45 am – 1:00 pm	

Please observe each site's arrival and departure arrangements. During sessions, only DBS-checked, authorised staff have unsupervised access to children, in line with our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy.

Term Dates & Holidays

The Madrasa year runs across six terms, broadly following the pattern below. Term 4 falls during Ramadan, when timings may be adjusted; parents will be notified in advance of any changes.



A full calendar showing exact term dates, holidays, exam weeks, parents' meetings, and award ceremonies is issued separately at the start of the year and is available from the admin at any time.

If your child will be absent for any reason, please notify the admin beforehand by messaging 07778 020745 on WhatsApp. Absence without notice is treated as unauthorised, and absences other than genuine sickness or absolute emergencies will also be regarded as unauthorised – see Attendance & Punctuality below.

The Madrasa Community

Our Team

Mufti Didar Hasan

Co-Founder & Head of Education

Alimah Zulfa Tanzim

Co-Founder, Senior Teacher & Manager

Mufti Mehdi Hasan

Assistant Head Teacher

Mawlana Nasir Ahmed

Senior Teacher

Our senior teachers are supported by a wider team of male and female teachers across both our Chatham and Gillingham sites.

Safeguarding

Darul-ilm Kent is committed to safeguarding and promoting the welfare of every child in our care. Safeguarding is everyone's responsibility, staff, volunteers, and parents alike, and any concern about a child's welfare is always taken seriously, whatever the circumstances.

Designated Safeguarding Lead (DSL)

Abdul-Lateef Agiri, Teacher — 07446 788597

Deputy DSL

Hanif Uddin, Administrator — 07368 446235

If you ever have a safeguarding concern about any child, please contact the DSL or Deputy DSL directly. Our full Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy is published on our website and available from the admin office at any time.



Parents' Code of Conduct & Communication

Parents' Code of Conduct & Working Together

Your child's progress depends on a genuine partnership between home and Madrasa. At enrolment, every family signs our Parents' Code of Conduct & Parent Agreement, which sets out what we ask of you and what you can expect from us. In summary, we ask parents to:



Support a set daily routine of home learning (see Home Learning below).



Ensure their child attends every session, only missing a day for a genuine emergency, with the admin notified beforehand.



Communicate any concern or disagreement through the proper channel, Head Administrator or Head Teacher, rather than in front of children or in public or public groups.



Treat all staff, volunteers, and other families with courtesy and respect, consistent with Islamic manners (adab).

The full Parents' Code of Conduct & Parent Agreement sets out these commitments in detail and forms part of your enrolment.



Communication, Group Chats & Social Media

We communicate with parents primarily through WhatsApp. When your child is enrolled, you are added to two parent WhatsApp groups, and we ask that all parents remain active in both:

The Parents' Group

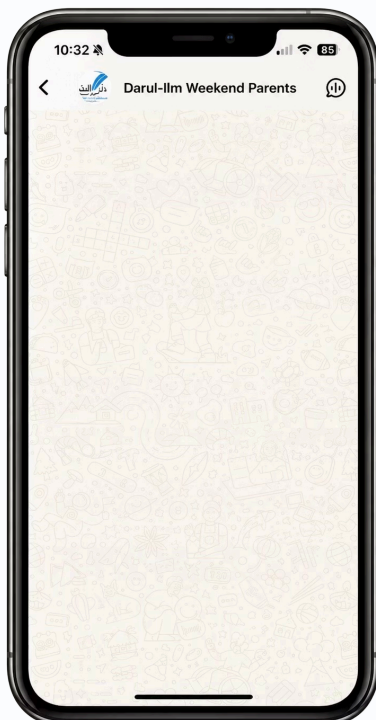
A broadcast-only group used for all important Madrasa announcements, reminders, and notices. Only the Madrasa can post in this group.

The Parents & Teachers Discussion Group

An open group where parents and teachers can discuss questions or matters relating to the children's learning.

Alongside these groups, you can also reach us via the admin phone number or in person by appointment. Please use these channels for anything you need to raise with staff, rather than personal numbers.

The Discussion Group, and any other parent WhatsApp groups, are a helpful way to stay connected, but please keep them respectful and constructive: they are not the channel for complaints, disputes, or negative comments about staff, volunteers, or other families — those should always be raised directly with the Administrator or Head Teacher. Likewise, we ask that parents do not post negative, derogatory, or disparaging comments about the Madrasa, its staff, volunteers, or other families on social media. Any concern is best resolved directly with us, and we are always willing to listen. Any such behaviour may lead to termination of the child's enrollment.



Darul-ilm Weekend Parents



Darul-ilm Parents Discussion

The Curriculum

What Your Child Will Learn

Every child begins with Qa'idah, learning to read Arabic letters and words correctly, before progressing to reading the Qur'an itself. As a general benchmark, a child should move from Qa'idah into Qur'an reading within one to two years.

Alongside Qur'an and Qa'idah reading, children learn and memorise selected surahs and du'as with correct tajwīd. Alongside this, they also study:

Aqīdah Belief	Fiqh Ṭahārah, Ṣalāh, Ṣawm, Zakāh, Ḥajj and 'Umrah, etc.	Sīrah The life of the Prophet ﷺ
Tārīkh Starting from the stories of the Prophets and the companions	Hadīth Sayings of the Prophet	Akhlāq Good character
Ādāb Etiquettes		

Home Learning

Consistent practice at home is just as important as time spent in class. As a parent or guardian, you are responsible for making sure your child has a set daily routine for Islamic learning at home, and for making sure that routine is actually followed. This means ensuring your child:

- Spends 20 to 30 minutes on Islamic learning at home every day, as part of a regular, set routine.
- Practises their Qa'idah or Qur'an reading that is set by their every day during this time.
- Learns any surah or du'a homework set by their teacher during this same time.
- Signs and dates their homework/communication diary every day, confirming that this has been done.

The Madrasa shares two YouTube playlists to support this daily practice, sent to parents via the Parents' WhatsApp group:

- Qa'idah reading playlist — https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2YwrjxeEG4o&list=PLNB34CsMSLrukfyLQxc_dIHB1edo2PiCJ
- Surahs reading playlist — <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ZzsPePj2a8Q&list=PLNB34CsMSLruUV4xmL1s7zgoWF6anGv8p>

Assessments, Progress & Recognition

We track every child's progress closely so that any concern can be addressed early rather than only being noticed at exam time. Students aged 8 and above take part in regular assessments, and parents are kept informed of their child's progress and any concerns as they arise.

We recognise and reward positive attitudes, good behaviour, strong attendance, and achievement through a structured points system, certificates, and letters of commendation. Certificates are awarded for milestones such as completing the Qa'idah, memorising Sūrah Yāsīn, Sūrah as-Sajdah, Sūrah al-Wāq'ah, and Juz' 'Amma, and for subject assessments passed at 80% or above.

Names of students who achieve notable milestones are displayed on our Outstanding Achievement Board, and the Head Teacher's Award is presented once per term in recognition of exceptional effort, character, or contribution to the Madrasa.

Exams & Award Ceremony

Alongside the regular assessments described above, your child sits two formal exams each year:

- A mid-year exam, held in Term 3 (January).
- An end-of-year exam, held in June/July.

Every July, before the summer holidays, we hold an award ceremony to celebrate the year's achievements. Awards presented at the ceremony are based on each child's end-of-year exam results.

Special Educational Needs

The Madrasa takes a positive and inclusive approach towards supporting children with additional needs. If you have any concern about your child's progress or believe they may need additional support, please speak to their class teacher or the Head Teacher in the first instance so that we can work with you to meet their individual needs.

General Information

Uniform

Boys: a plain white thobe.

Girls: a black or navy blue abaya, with a headscarf (hijab) covering the entire head and hair.

Please ensure uniform is clean and in good repair, and that all clothing and belongings are clearly labelled with your child's name.

Attendance & Punctuality

We believe every child has the right to attend regularly, and it is the parent's responsibility to ensure they do so. Your child is expected to attend every session; days should only be missed for a genuine emergency, and you must notify the admin beforehand wherever possible, by messaging 07778 020745.

Parents must ensure their child maintains a minimum of 80% attendance across the academic year. Where attendance falls below this threshold, parents will be invited to a review meeting with the Head Teacher to discuss the reasons and agree a plan going forward. Continued low attendance without good reason, or failure to attend the review meeting, may result in the child's application being withdrawn.

Behaviour

Our approach to behaviour reflects Islamic values of respect, kindness, and self-discipline (adab), alongside UK safeguarding good practice. For children aged 5 to 6, our approach is entirely positive and developmental: gentle verbal redirection, consistent routine, and positive reinforcement – sanctions are never used with this age group.

For pupils aged 7 and above, a fair and consistent sanctions ladder applies alongside a structured rewards system, beginning with verbal reminders and escalating only where needed. We take a zero-tolerance approach to bullying and to any form of child-on-child abuse. Full detail is set out in our Behaviour Policy, which is published on our website and available from the admin office at any time.

Health, Medical Information & Personal Property

Please keep the Madrasa informed of any medical condition, allergy, or additional need your child has, and ensure emergency contact details are always kept up to date, so that staff can respond appropriately and reach you quickly if needed.

Please avoid sending children in with valuable items or large sums of money. All belongings should be clearly labelled with your child's name; the Madrasa cannot accept responsibility for the loss, theft, or damage of personal property.

Photography & Social Media

From time to time, we take photos and videos during classes, events, and celebrations. Photos taken for our own internal records need no separate decision from you, and Islamic codes of conduct and modesty, with particular care for our girls, are applied at all times in everything we photograph or share.

At enrolment, you are asked to choose one of three permission levels for your child appearing in photos or videos shared more widely (full permission, limited permission, or no permission) as set out in full in the Parents' Code of Conduct & Parent Agreement. You can change your preference at any time by letting the Head Administrator know.

Fees, Withdrawal & Policies

Fees & Payment

Fees are charged per academic year according to the number of children enrolled from the same family, as shown below. Parents may choose to pay in a single upfront payment, in two instalments, or in 11 monthly instalments (Option C shown below).

Children enrolled	Annual fee - incl. resources fee (Option A)	Resources fee (one-off due 1 Aug)	Option B (2 instalments, each)	Monthly (Option C, x11)
1 child	£575	£25	£275	£50
2 siblings	£1,030	£40	£495	£90
3 siblings	£1,545	£60	£742.50	£135
4 siblings	£2,040	£60	£990	£180

Direct debit via the parent portal is our standard payment method. Cash payments are accepted within the first week of the month, provided the admin is messaged the same day confirming the amount and date paid. Fees are non-refundable once a place is accepted, and families experiencing genuine financial hardship are encouraged to contact the Head Administrator to discuss support before a payment is missed. Full detail, including our late payment and escalation process, is set out in our Fees Policy.

Withdrawing Your Child

Parents wishing to withdraw their child must give at least 28 days' written notice to the Head Administrator. Fees remain payable for the full notice period. Full detail is set out in our Fees Policy.

Policies You Will Receive at Enrolment

Alongside this handbook, every family is given the following at enrolment, as these apply immediately:

- Parents' Code of Conduct & Parent Agreement
- Fees Policy

Our Safeguarding & Child Protection Policy and Behaviour Policy are also published in full on our website, and available from the admin office at any time.

If you have not yet completed the enrolment form (google form) sent to you, please do so as soon as possible – your child's place is not confirmed until this and the resources fee are both done.

If you have any queries, please contact the admin office on 07778 020745 or info@darulilmchatham.com

Jazākumullāhu khayran for entrusting us with your child's Islamic education,

Mufti Didar Hasan

Co-Founder & Head of Education